First, read the following sets of limericks with missing words. Now, listen to them being read out aloud by your teacher or played on the recorder. As you enjoy the absurd fun, complete the verse with what you hear. You may listen to them again, if required.

I

A wonderful bird is the (i)_____
His beak can hold more than his (ii) _____can.
He can hold in his beak
Enough food for a (iii) _____!
But I'll be darned if I know how the Peli-can?

II

There once was a (iv) _____at the zoo
Who always had something to do
When it (v) _____him, you know,
To go to and fro,
He (vi) _____ it and went fro and to.

III

There once was a (vii) _____ little bunny
Who I thought was sweet and (viii) ____
He ate all the carrots,
And looked at the (ix) _____
And that was my cute little (x) _____.

H. Speaking Activity

Work with a partner. Read the following questions and share your views with the class. Have you heard of the phrase 'cat's paw'? The meaning is similar to that of 'firing from the other's shoulder'. 'Cat's paw' refers to a person who is used unwittingly or unwillingly by another person to accomplish his own purpose.

a. This phrase originates from the fable 'The Monkey and the Cat'. Explain how Macavity contradicts the phrase 'cat's paw'.

b. 'When the mouse laughs at the cat, there is a hole nearby.' Explain the meaning of this statement to your friends.

c. Compose your own limericks on **an elephant, a peacock and a butterfly.** Read it out to your class.

9. Parallel Reading

The Microbe

The Microbe is so very small
You cannot make him out at all,
But many sanguine people hope
To see him through a microscope.
His jointed tongue that lies beneath
A hundred curious rows of teeth;
His seven tufted tails with lots
Of lovely pink and purple spots,
On each of which a pattern stands,
Composed of forty separate bands;
His eyebrows of a tender green;
All these have never yet been seen--
But Scientists, who ought to know,
Assure us that they must be so....
Oh! let us never, never doubt
What nobody is sure about!

Hillaire Belloc



04-B-Poem-Macavity - The Mystery Cat.indd 131 11-01-2019 15:39:32